



11- EXAMPLES OF INTRODUCTIONS AND CONCLUSIONS

o General Introductions

- *As it is well known, a controversy has arisen (= has began) recently over this topic. However, there are some people who keep saying (that) it has been a long time since it has been hitting the headlines. In order to clarify it, I am going to compare the pros and cons.*
- *Football hooliganism has been a topic of debate among sociologists and the press for many years. (From Selectividad 1994/1995)*
- *Although this topic has been discussed for many times before, there is not a clear conclusion yet. In order to clarify it, I am going to compare the pros and cons.*
- *I chuckle to myself every time I think about this. I am perceived as a mild-mannered, intelligent individual until I mention that I am involved in (riflery).*
- *I chuckle to myself every time I think about this. I have sometimes thought about this topic but without reaching a final conclusion. Maybe, by writing down the pros and cons, I might obtain a good conclusion.*

Vocabulary:

Chuckle = Reirse

Perceived = Observado, percibido

Mild-mannered (=gentle and polite) = Apacible, dulce y educado

Riflery = tiro al blanco.

o General Conclusions

- *In view of the above, we can clearly reach the conclusion that...*
- *Once all the points have been considered, pros and cons, we can see that...*
- *All in all, we can understand that there is not either a clear solution or an easy answer. However, if we consider the pros and cons viewed above, ...*
- *Understanding that this topic is not an easy one, we can, however, see that...*

- Excerpt from Raymond E Feist's novel; *A Kingdom Besieged*

- *However, one thing is sure: how the truth is seen often defines the truth.*

o Examples of Introductions and Conclusions for compositions

2010

a) Recycling should be obligatory and local authorities should penalize those who don't recycle. Discuss.

I: *To discuss this topic by analyzing the pros and cons might give a clear idea about if, as the title says, companies which do not recycle should be penalized.*

C: *To summarize, we see that it is not just a matter of penalizing but it is more about education. It is something about how to obtain a middle point between progress and environment.*



- b) Write a formal letter to your local authority demanding new measures to improve recycling levels in your municipality.

I: Dear Sir/Madan,

I am writing to you about improving the recycling levels in our municipality by adding new measures.

C: *In view of the above, we would be most grateful if you could add new measures to help local residents to recycle much more than now.*

*Yours faithfully,
(Your name)*

2009

- a) Imagine you are a teacher in a primary school. Write a letter to Professor Philip James asking for advice on how to prevent obesity among your students.

I: Dear Professor Philip James,

I am writing to you in order to obtain advice about how to prevent obesity among our students.

C: *I would like to express in advance my deepest gratitude for your concern about this matter.*

*Yours sincerely,
(your name)*

- b) Write a composition with the following title: "Advertising campaigns on junk food must not be addressed to children and teenagers."

I: *As it is well known, nowadays there is a huge problem with the obesity. Unfortunately, it is not just for adult people but also for children and teenagers. By analyzing the pros and cons of the advertising campaigns on junk food, I am going to try to add my modest point of view.*

C: *In view of the above, I strongly believe (that) children as well as teenagers should be protected against junk food. Otherwise, they will suffer from serious illness once they become adults. It is in our hands to avoid this right now, before it becomes too late.*

2008

- a) The most important musical experience in my life

I: *I will never forget the last glimpse of the stage when I was just nine years old. It was a winter foggy day and I had been taken to the school by my parents....*

C: *All in all, it was an unforgettable experience which will be with me for the rest of my life. Who knows, maybe if one day I have children, I will tell them.*

- b) In your opinion, are the Spice Girls perfect role models, as Sherri Reeve Claimed?



I: Before reaching the conclusion if Spice Girls are the perfect role model, as claimed by Sherry Reeve, I would prefer to start by analyzing what is a perfect role model.

C: It is clear then, that Spice Girls are (are not) the perfect role models as described by Sherry on her text.

2007

a) Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of drastically reducing the use of private vehicles and increasing public transportation in towns and cities

I: It is obvious that the level of pollution in our cities is increasing dramatically day by day. Therefore, a measure should be taken in order to reduce it. Only by analyzing the pros and cons of using public transportation to reduce these levels can give us a clear idea about the most effective way of reducing pollution levels.

C: As discussed above, it is not so easy to reduce the use of private vehicles as our public transportation system does not work as it should be or we would like to. Therefore, only by improving it we will be able to convince people to leave their vehicles at home. Unless council cities take further action to restrict them, this situation will not change. Actually, cities such as London, Rome etc... have already done it and it is good for their air quality.

b) How can you help to protect our environment?

I: As it is well known, a controversy has arisen (= has began) recently over this topic. However, there are some people who keep saying (that) it has been a long time since it has been hitting the headlines. In order to clarify it, I am going to compare the pros and cons about some measures which, not only by me but by most of people, are made to help the environment.

C: Taking everything into account, it is a matter of spending time and money on education in order to convince most of people to recycle, divide the rubbish etc... I do so every day. However, it will not help our environment unless everybody does the same.

2006

a) Write a composition with the following title: "Advantages and disadvantages of banning smoking in bars and restaurants".

I: As it is well known, a controversy has arisen (= has began) recently over this topic. However, there are some people who keep saying (that) it has been a long time since it has been hitting the headlines. In order to clarify it, I am going to compare the pros and cons about banning smoking in bars and restaurants.

C: Needless to say that this is a topic where there will always be people against because (for) there are business which might lose money as well as customers who feel better by smoking while they are drinking something. However, health should be considered first, before money. Otherwise, profits would be more important than people.



b) Write a letter to Kevin Barron (chairman of the Parliamentary Health Committee) supporting his proposal.

I: Dear Mr. Kevin Barron,

I am writing to you about supporting your proposal...

C: *I would not like to finish this letter without expressing my total support for your proposal and state my gratitude for the contribution you are presently making.*

Yours sincerely,

2005

a) "Childhood and teenage smoking, reasons and health effects"

I: *Although this topic has been discussed for many times before, there is not a clear conclusion yet. In order to clarify it, I am going to compare the pros and cons.*

C: *All things considered, public authorities must take action to stop the rise in childhood and teenager smoking. Their health will depend on the government prompt response. Otherwise, their health will suffer from the smoking effects. The more time it is left, the worse the problem will become.*

2004

a) Do you prefer spending your evenings listening to music or doing something else? Why?

I: *I chuckle to myself every time I think about this. I am perceived as a mild-mannered, intelligent individual until I mention that I am involved in (riflery). Yes, I have to admit that I prefer spending my evenings shooting. However, I would like to write down the reasons why I prefer doing so to listening to music.*

C: *As far as I am concerned, I prefer spending my evenings shooting to listening to music. As I have tried to explain above, I enjoy myself much more with this sport than with anything else. Actually, the more time I spend on it, the better I feel.*

b) Technology and music nowadays. Write your opinion.

I: *Nowadays technology and music are more and more linked. We cannot think about music without taking into account technology. I am going to write my personal opinion in the following paragraphs, leaving clear in advance that this is just a modest point of view which should not be considered more than a simple opinion which, at the end, could be wrong.*

C: *All things considered, it is clear that there are musicians who prefer classical methods without being altered by any technology. However, there are also others who are open-minded about investigating new sounds. All in all, as I see it, everything is perfect. We will be able to enjoy with all sort of sounds.*

2001



a) How to organize an enjoyable holiday abroad.

I: *I have spent a whole year concentrated in my studies. So, it is time to start thinking about my future holidays in*

C: *Well, I believe I have everything under control now. Times tables, transportations, hotels etc... I am looking forward to going there. It is going to be great!!*

2000

a) Unrestrained growth and overpopulation may cause an environmental breakdown and question our survival on Earth

I: *As it is well known, a controversy has arisen (= has began) recently over this topic. However, there are some people who keep saying (that) it has been a long time since it has been hitting the headlines. In order to clarify it, I am going to compare the pros and cons of having overpopulation because (for) as well as the obvious environmental breakdown, it might offer some benefits.*

C: *As I see it, it is clear that if governments start working on this serious problem, they can find solutions. It would not be fair to leave some people without medical care just because of overpopulation and, on the other hand, not let their relatives die by giving them all the necessary.*

12- EXAMPLES OF COMPOSITIONS

o **A small story. The same with different words**

- Excerpt from Haruki Murakami's novel; *Kafka on the Shore*

"Well, first you ¹⁹⁶stab your bayonet deep into his belly, then you twist it sideways. That ¹⁹⁷rips the ¹⁹⁸guts to ¹⁹⁹ribbons. Then the guy dies a horrible, slow, painful death. But if you just stab without twisting, then your enemy can jump up and rip your guts to ²⁰⁰shreds. = *Bien, primero tú clavabas tu bayoneta bien honda en su ombligo, entonces la retuerces en ambos lados. Eso rasga los intestinos a jirones. Entonces el tipo muere de una muerte horrible, lenta, dolorosa. Pero si tu sólo acuchillas sin retorcer, entonces el enemigo puede saltar y rasgar tus intestinos a tiras.*

¹⁹⁶ Stab: puñalada/cuchillada/apuñalar/acuchillar

¹⁹⁷ Rip: rasgar/ romper / arrancar

¹⁹⁸ Gut: Intestino/barriga

¹⁹⁹ Ribbons = A jirones/a pedados/ a trozos

²⁰⁰ Shred: cortar a tiras/destruir/triturar/tira/cortar a tiras/hecho a jirones/tira/trozo/cortar a tiras



- Ideas from the studied excerpts

o **Examples for a possible introduction**

A) My head's full of all kinds of thoughts/ideas, all intertwined and tangled. I can't write down the difference between one thing and another. Besides, I can feel my face ²⁰¹tighten up, I'm so nervous that my heart's ²⁰²pounding and I found it hard to breathe. I'm trying to get rid of all these ghosts which live inside myself and just appear in the critical events such as exams like this one and concentrate on this composition ²⁰³thoroughly.

B) This new composition (about (title)) leaves my mind in a state of wonder which allows no room for active thought. However, as there is no alternative but to write it, I will try to do my best by analysing the pros and cons and finishing with my own opinion.

o **Composition: TV**

I am in a sea of wonders. I think strange things, which I dare not confess to my own soul. I am sure you must be wondering whether I am out of my mind or not to have such thoughts but let me explain myself, please.

On the one hand, when I am watching an interesting television programme I feel blood may drain out of me and do not notice anything at all. I have to admit TV is absorbing. I am sure you will understand that amid the entertainment and enthusiasm there is not too much difference. I could spend hours watching TV and have the feeling I have just been watching it for two minutes.

On the other hand, TV causes me loads of troubles. My studies are not as good as they should be. Besides, my parents are always angry with me. They keep telling me I am way out of line. Well, I can almost sense my life expanding just like a river whose waters have begun to swell. And everything is because of TV.

As I see it, TV is like the beauty and the beast which has the best and the worst. The more you watch it, the more you like it. It is poisonous. To be honest, it is better to stay away. [220 Words]

²⁰¹ Tighten up: Más seria, más estricta

²⁰² Pound: Palpitar, aporrear, machacar, retumbar.

²⁰³ Thoroughly: A fondo, a conciencia, minuciosamente.